

Assignment 3

Peripheral Troubleshooting Theory

Task (1):

List 5 common issues users face with USB keyboards or mice on laptops, and write one possible solution for each.

Ans.

1. USB keyboard or mouse is not detected:

- Unplug the device and reconnect it to another USB port. Restart the laptop if needed.

2. Device works intermittently:

- Check for a loose USB connection and try a different USB port or replace the damaged cable.

3. Keyboard keys or mouse buttons are not responding:

- Clean the keyboard or mouse and update/reinstall the USB or device drivers.

4. Mouse cursor is lagging or freezing:

- Close unnecessary background programs, update drivers, and try using a different USB port.

5. USB port is not working:

- Test the device on another USB port or another computer. If the port is faulty, update USB drivers or have the port repaired.

Task (2)

Simulate a troubleshooting flow: Your Bluetooth headphones are not connecting to your phone. Write the exact step-by-step actions you would take to diagnose and fix the issue, mentioning any settings or indicators you would check.

Ans.

Bluetooth Headphones Troubleshooting Flow:

Step 1: Check Battery Level

- Make sure the Bluetooth headphones have enough battery.
- Charge them for 15–30 minutes if the battery is low.

Step 2: Turn On Bluetooth

- Open Settings → Bluetooth on the phone.
- Ensure Bluetooth is turned ON.

Step 3: Put Headphones in Pairing Mode

- Press and hold the Power/Bluetooth button until the LED starts flashing (usually blue/red or white).
- This flashing light indicates the headphones are ready to pair.

Step 4: Pair the Devices

- On the phone, tap the headphones' name from the available devices list.
- Wait for the status to change to Connected.

Step 5: Forget and Reconnect

- If the headphones appear but won't connect:

- Tap the Settings icon next to the device name.
- Select Forget or Unpair.

Step 6: Check for Existing Connections

- Ensure the headphones are not already connected to another phone, tablet, or laptop.

Step 7: Restart Both Devices

- Turn the headphones off and back on.
- Restart the phone.
- Try pairing again after both devices restart.

Step 8: Check Bluetooth Range

- Keep the headphones within 1–2 meters of the phone during pairing.

Step 9: Update Software

- Check for phone software updates in Settings → Software Update.

Step 10: Reset the Headphones

- Put the headphones back into pairing mode and reconnect them.

Step 11: Test with Another Device

- Try connecting the headphones to another phone or laptop.

Task (3)

A user reports that their external webcam is not detected during a Zoom call on Windows 10. Write a checklist of 6 things to check or try to resolve the problem. Hint: Consider device manager, privacy settings, and app permissions.

Ans.

1. Check the USB Connection

- Ensure the webcam is securely connected to the USB port.

2. Check Device Manager

- Open Device Manager (Win + X → Device Manager).
- Expand Cameras or Imaging Devices.

3. Verify Camera Privacy Settings

- Go to Settings → Privacy → Camera.

- Turn on Allow access to the camera on this device.

4. **Check Zoom Camera Settings**

- Open Zoom → Settings → Video.

5. **Restart the Webcam and Computer**

- Unplug and reconnect the webcam.
- Restart the computer and reopen Zoom to check if the camera is detected.

6. **Test the Webcam in Another App**

- Open the Camera app in Windows or another video application.

Task (4)

You are helping a friend whose printer is showing 'offline' status on their PC. Describe how you would use the Windows Troubleshooter tool to try to fix the issue, and explain what information the tool provides during the process.

Ans.

Using Windows Troubleshooter to Fix a Printer Showing "Offline"

Step 1: Open Settings

- Press Windows + I to open Settings.
- Go to Update & Security → Troubleshoot → Additional troubleshooters.
- Select Printer, then click Run the troubleshooter.

Step 2: Select the Printer

- Choose the printer that is showing Offline from the list.
- Click Next to begin the troubleshooting process.

Step 3: Allow Windows to Scan

- The troubleshooter will automatically check for common printer problems, such as:
- Printer is set to Offline.
- Print Spooler service is not running.
- Incorrect or outdated printer driver.
- Connection problems (USB or Wi-Fi).
- Default printer configuration issues

Step 4: Apply Suggested Fixes

- If Windows finds a problem, it will display the issue and suggest a fix.
- Click Apply this fix if prompted.

Step 5: Test the Printer

- After the troubleshooting is complete, print a test page to check whether the printer is back online and working correctly.
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